

LBDG

Leadership Bureau for Disclosure Guidance

H R O P E R A T I O N A L T O O L K I T

Organizational Readiness for a Major Paradigm-Shifting Announcement

A practical toolkit for HR Directors, CHROs, and People Managers. Contains scorecards to fill in, a 2-hour leadership workshop guide, role-specific communication checklists, and weekly recovery monitoring tools. Designed to be used, not just read.

5 tools

HR · People Managers ·
CHRO

Edition 2025

What is inside this toolkit:

- ▶ Tool 1 — Organizational Readiness Scorecard (fill-in, 8 dimensions)
- ▶ Tool 2 — Leadership Workshop Guide (2 hours, facilitation script included)
- ▶ Tool 3 — Communication Cascade Checklist (role-specific, with timing)
- ▶ Tool 4 — Manager Action Guide (phase-by-phase checklist)
- ▶ Tool 5 — Recovery Monitoring Dashboard (weekly KPI tracker)

HOW TO USE THIS TOOLKIT

This toolkit is designed around three phases. Start before any announcement — ideally 30+ days in advance. The readiness scorecard and workshop should happen in this window. The checklists activate at announcement. The recovery dashboard runs for 90 days after.

	PHASE 1 J-30 to J-7 PREPARATION	PHASE 2 J0 to J+7 ANNOUNCEMENT	PHASE 3 J+8 to J+90 RECOVERY
Tools to use:	Tool 1 — Scorecard Tool 2 — Workshop	Tool 3 — Comm Cascade Tool 4 — Manager Guide	Tool 5 — Recovery KPIs Tool 4 (ongoing)

TOOL 1 — ORGANIZATIONAL READINESS SCORECARD

PHASE 1 — Complete this before the announcement.
Score twice: once today, once after a drill.

 **Instructions:** Score each dimension 1 (unprepared) to 5 (fully ready). Fill in the "Today" column first. Run a simulation drill (see Tool 2), then score again in the "After Drill" column. The gap between the two scores shows where you are most vulnerable under pressure.

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5	Priority action if score < 3
<i>1 = Unprepared 3 = Partial 5 = Fully Ready</i>						<i>Circle your score → fill in action</i>
1. Leadership Alignment <i>Leaders agree on response and messaging</i>	1	2	3	4	5	
2. Communication Readiness <i>Channels, templates, and approval chain ready</i>	1	2	3	4	5	
3. Psychological Safety <i>Staff feel safe raising concerns without fear</i>	1	2	3	4	5	
4. Role Clarity <i>Everyone knows what to do and who decides</i>	1	2	3	4	5	
5. Manager Capability <i>Managers trained and equipped to lead</i>	1	2	3	4	5	
6. Employee Support Access <i>EAP visible, known, and accessible 24/7</i>	1	2	3	4	5	
7. Recovery Monitoring <i>KPIs defined and tracking system ready</i>	1	2	3	4	5	
8. Overall Shock Absorption <i>Organization can absorb a major disruption</i>	1	2	3	4	5	

Total Score	Readiness Level	Recommended Action
8–16	HIGH RISK — Major gaps	Run Tool 2 workshop immediately. Brief leadership this week.
17–26	MODERATE — Partial preparation	Prioritize dimensions scored 1-2. Run drill within 2 weeks.

27–32	GOOD — Minor gaps only	Run drill to confirm. Update communication templates.
33–40	STRONG — Ready to respond	Maintain quarterly drills. Monitor leading indicators.

TOOL 2 — LEADERSHIP WORKSHOP GUIDE (2 HOURS)

PHASE 1 — Run this workshop 2-4 weeks before expected announcement. Maximum 12 participants.

Setup

Who to invite	CEO or MD, HR Director, 4-6 senior managers, Communications lead, Legal (optional)
Room setup	U-shape or round table. No screens. Printed scenario cards provided by facilitator (see Annex).
Materials	Printed scorecard results, 3 scenario briefs (1 per table group), blank decision trees, sticky notes, Action Log sheet
Ground rules	Chatham House rules — no attribution outside the room. "We don't know" is a valid answer. Challenge assumptions openly.
Facilitator role	Keeps time strictly. Does not give answers. Captures decisions. Escalates silence with "What would break first?"

Agenda

Time	Block	Facilitator Activity	Deliverable
0:00–0:15	Framing	"Why we are here — the readiness gap. What we know, what we don't, what we need to decide." Present scorecard results anonymized.	Shared understanding of gaps
0:15–0:30	Scenario Brief	Distribute scenario cards (Soft / Confirmation / Hard). 5 min silent reading. 10 min Q&A on facts only — no speculation from facilitator.	Shared scenario map
0:30–1:10	Small Group Work	3 groups, each assigned one scenario. Question: "What breaks first in your team?" Complete decision tree template. "What do you need from HR / Leadership in H+4?"	Decision tree per scenario
1:10–1:30	Plenary Synthesis	Each group presents in 5 min. Facilitator captures: (1) common failure points, (2) disagreements, (3) resource gaps. Red-team challenge: "What assumption are we making that could be wrong?"	Shared risk map
1:30–1:50	Action Planning	Complete Action Log: what, who, by when. Confirm: who is the disclosure decision owner? What triggers	Action Log signed

		activation?	
1:50–2:00	Close	Confirm next drill date. Confirm communication template owners. Remind: Chatham House rules apply.	Next steps confirmed

Facilitator Script — Key Phrases

TIP

Opening: "Today we are not predicting whether this happens. We are testing whether we are ready if it does. The question is not 'do you believe it' — the question is 'what breaks first in your team and what do you need to fix that before we need to use it.'"

TIP

When the group gets stuck: "What would have to be true for this to go badly? What is the one thing we are assuming that we haven't tested?" Give 2 minutes of silent writing before asking for answers out loud.

TIP

When someone dominates: "Let's hear from someone who hasn't spoken yet. [Name], from your team's perspective, what breaks first?" Anonymous sticky notes on the wall before group discussion also work well for sensitive topics.

TIP

On speculation about content: "We are not here to determine what the announcement will say. We are here to determine whether our organization can function well regardless of what it says. Let's return to: what does your team need from you in the first 4 hours?"

TOOL 3 — COMMUNICATION CASCADE CHECKLIST

PHASE 2 — Activate at J0. Each checkbox must be completed and signed off by the named role.

TIMING	Timing principle (SHRM): Speed with accuracy. Managers must be equipped BEFORE the all-staff message goes out — never after. The cascade is: C-suite first, managers second, all staff immediately after. Run all three in parallel channels.
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Done	Owner	Action	By When
H + 0 TO H + 1 — C-SUITE INTERNAL BRIEF			
☐	CEO / MD	Brief entire leadership team (C-suite + -1 reports). Facts only — what was announced, source, and what we know. No speculation.	H+1
☐	General Counsel	Confirm no Reg FD / AMF disclosure obligation triggered. Sign off before any external communication.	H+1
☐	HR Director	Confirm EAP is on standby mode. Brief EAP provider that demand may spike.	H+1
☐	Comms Lead	Hold all outbound media / social. No statement without CEO + Legal sign-off.	H+1
H + 1 TO H + 4 — MANAGER BRIEFING (BEFORE ALL-STAFF)			
☐	HR Director	Send Manager Brief Pack (see Tool 4) to all people managers. Confirm receipt.	H+2
☐	HR Director	Host 30-min manager call (optional, recommended if Scenario C). Answer questions. Align on messaging.	H+3
☐	All Managers	Read the Manager Brief Pack. Know the script. Know the EAP number.	H+3
☐	Comms Lead	Draft all-staff message (use template below). Obtain CEO + Legal sign-off.	H+3
H + 4 — ALL-STAFF COMMUNICATION (MULTI-CHANNEL)			
☐	CEO	Email all-staff message sent. Subject: "An important message from [CEO name]."	H+4
☐	Comms Lead	Message posted on intranet and internal Slack/Teams simultaneously.	H+4
☐	HR Director	EAP number included prominently in all-staff message. Activated in-message.	H+4
☐	All Managers	Forward email to own team with personal note: "I'm available if you want to talk."	H+4

H + 4 T O H + 2 4 — T E A M - L E V E L F O L L O W - U P			
☐	All Managers	Run 15-min team check-in. Use script from Tool 4. No cancellations.	H+24
☐	HR Director	Publish FAQ on intranet (first version — 5 core questions). Update as new questions come in.	H+8
☐	HR Director	Monitor: EAP call volume, manager escalations, absence requests. Report to CEO.	H+24
☐	Comms Lead	Monitor external media for employee-relevant developments. Brief HR if new info emerges.	H+24
H + 2 4 T O J + 7 — S T A B I L I Z A T I O N			
☐	HR Director	Daily signal summary to CEO: EAP volume, absences, manager escalations, mood indicators.	Daily
☐	All Managers	Individual check-ins with any team member who requested one or showed stress signals.	J+3
☐	HR Director	Update FAQ. Run pulse survey (3 questions maximum — anonymized).	J+5
☐	CEO	Second all-staff message: acknowledge the week, reaffirm stability, outline next steps.	J+7

All-Staff Message Template

Subject: An important message from [First Name Last Name, Title]

Team,

By now many of you are aware of [describe the announcement in one factual sentence. No speculation. Only confirmed information from official sources].

I want to address this directly. [One sentence on what the company knows today. One sentence on what is still unclear.] We will share updates as confirmed information becomes available — we will not speculate.

What this means for us: [One sentence. Example: "Our operations continue normally" OR "We are actively monitoring the situation and have activated our contingency plan."]

Your wellbeing matters. If you need to talk to someone, our Employee Assistance Programme is available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week at [EAP number]. It is free, confidential, and no referral is needed.

Your manager will be in touch today. Our FAQ is available at [intranet link]. Next update from me: [date/time].

[Signature]

TOOL 4 — MANAGER ACTION GUIDE

PHASES 1, 2 AND 3 — This guide is for people managers only. Print and keep accessible.

ACTION

Your role: You are the most important factor in your team's resilience. Not the CEO message. Not the HR policy. You. Your team will watch how you react before they listen to what you say. Stay calm, stay factual, stay available.

What You Can and Cannot Say

YOU CAN SAY ✓	YOU CANNOT SAY ✗
"I don't have all the answers yet, and that's okay."	<i>"I personally think this means..."</i>
"The company is monitoring the situation and will update us."	<i>"Don't worry, this won't affect us." (unless confirmed)</i>
"If you need support, the EAP is available 24/7 at [number]."	<i>"You shouldn't be stressed about this."</i>
"Your reaction is completely normal. These are unusual circumstances."	<i>Any religious or existential interpretation of the announcement.</i>
"I'm available if you want to talk — even briefly."	<i>Speculation about what will happen next.</i>
"We don't know yet. I'll share updates as soon as I have confirmed information."	<i>"Between us..." — there is no between us on this topic.</i>

15-Minute Team Check-In Script

▶ Run this within 24 hours of the announcement. In-person or video. Not optional.

Step	Say this (adapt to your own voice)
Open (1 min)	<i>"I wanted to check in with all of you directly. I've read the all-staff message and I imagine some of you may have questions or feelings about what's been announced."</i>
Normalize (2 min)	<i>"Whatever you're feeling right now — curious, unsettled, confused, or completely fine — all of that is valid. There is no wrong reaction. I want this to be a space where you can be honest."</i>
Facts only (3 min)	<i>"Here is what we know as confirmed fact: [one or two sentences maximum]. Here is what we do not know yet: [one sentence]. I will share updates as soon as I have them, and I won't speculate."</i>
Open floor (5 min)	<i>"Does anyone have a question I can address? If I don't know the answer, I'll say so and find out. [Pause. Allow silence — give people 10 seconds before moving on.]"</i>

Support (2 min)	<i>"Our EAP is available 24/7 at [number]. It is entirely confidential — I will never know if you call. If you want to talk to me directly, I'm available [specify when/how]."</i>
Close (2 min)	<i>"We continue our work as normal. Next update from the company: [date]. My door is open. Thank you for your time."</i>

Escalation Decision Tree — When to Call HR

 Use this tree in the 72 hours after announcement and the following 30 days.

Signal observed	Level	Action
Team member asks general questions about the announcement	Normal	Use FAQ and your script. No escalation needed.
Team member expresses anxiety or is visibly distressed	Monitor	Private conversation. Share EAP number. Follow up in 48h.
Team member requests time off or adjustment	Routine HR	Discuss options. Loop in HR within 24h.
Team member is absent without contact after announcement	Moderate	Attempt contact. Report to HR within 24h.
Team member makes alarming statements or shows signs of crisis	URGENT	Call HR immediately. Do not leave the person alone.
Multiple team members showing distress simultaneously	URGENT	Call HR immediately. Request additional support resources.

TOOL 5 — RECOVERY MONITORING DASHBOARD

PHASE 3 — Fill in weekly, starting J+1. Share with HR Director and CEO every Friday.

Recovery is measured in three waves. Leading indicators (EAP use, pulse scores) move first. Lagging indicators (retention, productivity) confirm the trend 4-8 weeks later. Do not wait for lagging indicators to conclude that recovery is or is not happening.

KPI	Type	Frequency	Alert Threshold	Owner
WAVE 1 — 0 to 72 hours				
EAP call volume	Leading	Daily	>200% of baseline: escalate	HR Director
Manager escalations to HR	Leading	Daily	>3 per day: deploy additional resource	HR Director
All-staff message open rate	Leading	Once	<60%: resend via alternative channel	Comms Lead
Absence requests (unplanned)	Leading	Daily	>5% of workforce: flag to CEO	HR Director
WAVE 2 — Week 2 to Week 4				
Pulse survey sentiment	Leading	Weekly	Score <3.0/5: urgent HR intervention	HR Director
Psychological safety score	Leading	Bi-weekly	Drop >0.5 from baseline: manager coaching	HR Director
Absenteeism rate	Lagging	Weekly	>1.5x pre-event baseline: flag	HR Director
Manager check-in completion	Leading	Weekly	<80% completed: HR follow-up	HR Director
FAQ intranet page views	Leading	Weekly	Spike: update FAQ proactively	Comms Lead
WAVE 3 — Month 2 to Month 3				
Voluntary turnover rate	Lagging	Monthly	>1.5x baseline: exit interview analysis	HR Director
Productivity proxies	Lagging	Monthly	>15% drop from baseline: function review	CEO / COO
Burnout climate score	Lagging	Monthly	Score >3.5/5: structured intervention	HR Director
Work-life climate score	Lagging	Monthly	Sustained drop: flexible work review	HR Director

Weekly Recovery Report Template (1 page)

HR WEEKLY RECOVERY REPORT — Week [N] — [Date]

Overall status: ☐ On track ☐ Monitor ☐ Intervention needed

EAP calls this week: _____ vs baseline: _____ Trend: ☐ Up ☐ Stable ☐ Down

Unplanned absences: _____ Pulse score: _____/5 Manager escalations: _____

Top 3 signals this week:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Actions taken this week:

Recommended actions for next week:

SOURCES AND METHODOLOGY

Source	Applied In
SCORE Psychological Safety Instrument	Tool 1 — Readiness Scorecard dimensions. 6-item validated scale, Cronbach alpha 0.80.
SHRM Crisis Communication Guidelines	Tool 3 — Communication cascade timing and channel principles. Role-specific messaging framework.
Gilead Compass Scenario Workshop Agenda (2025)	Tool 2 — Workshop structure. 5-block agenda with breakout and synthesis phases.
EAP Recovery Study (PubMed 2024)	Tool 5 — EAP as leading indicator. Productivity improvement at 4 weeks and 6 months. Absenteeism as lagging indicator.
CDC COVID-19 Mental Health Guidance	Tool 4 — Escalation thresholds. 3-archetype model (Rationaliste, Anxieux, Déstabilisé).
9/11 Post-Event Mental Health Research (Stanford)	Tool 5 — Recovery wave framework. Social support and information quality as protective factors.

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